25900384

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY,

KOTTAYAM

MGU - UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR

EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCFIM200 - YOGIC SCIENCE AND PRACTICES

((2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes. **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understanding(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability

PART - A

MCQ

1.which ancient text expanded yoga by discussing self - realization and spiritual liberation ? [U] / [CO1]

d) upanishads

2.How does yoga help in dealing with workplace stress ? [U] / [CO1,CO2]

b) by reducing stress and improving coping skills

3.How does meditation in yoga affect mental clarity ? [U] / [CO1,CO2]

c) improves mental clarity and focus.

4.Regular practice of savasana improves : [U] / [CO3,CO6]

d) concentration and mental clarity

5.Marichyasana mainly twist the :
[U] / [CO3,CO6]

d) spine

6.Regular practice of vrikshasana helps in : [U] / [CO3,CO6]

a) developing focus and stability

7.chakrasana strengthens the arms and legs because: [U] / [CO3,CO6]

b) they support the body weight during the pose

8.which of the following best describes mindfulness [K] / [CO2]

c) paying attention to the present moment without judgement.

9.what is the goal of yoga in stress management ? [K] / [CO2]

d) promote balance of body and mind

10.which pranayama is known as the “breath of fire” that energizes the body and boosts vitality ? [K] / [CO4]

b) bhastrika pranayama

[1×10 = 10]

PART - B

SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

11. what is tantra yoga known for yogic traditions? [K] / [CO1, CO2,CO4]

Ans : tantra yoga (the path of rituals and energy)

Tantra means - “expansion” - using ritual mantras and meditative techniques.

Focuses on awaking inner energy (kundalini energy)

Energy control and inner harmony .

12. Analyze the relationship between knowledge and liberation in jnana yoga. [An] / [CO1, CO2,CO4]

Ans : Jnana (the path of knowledge)

Knowledge (jnana) :

- Is the primary means to achieve liberation (moksha) in Jnana Yoga.
- Through self-inquiry and discrimination, knowledge removes ignorance (avidya), revealing the true nature of the self (Atman) as Brahman.
- This realization leads to liberation, freeing the individual from the cycle of birth and death.

13.Define sukhasana and name some preparatory poses for it. [K] / [CO3, CO6]

- Sukhasana: A simple cross-legged seated pose, also known as Easy Pose, used for meditation and breathing exercises.
- It also relaxes the mind and calm the body.
- Reduces stress , anxiety and tension.
- Preparatory poses:
- Baddha Konasana (Butterfly Pose)
- Savasana (corse pose)
- Balasana (Child's Pose)
- Vajrasana (diamond pose)

14. Analyze how seated asanas help in calming the mind . [An] / [CO3, CO6]

Ans : Seated asanas :

- Promote relaxation and reduce physical tension
- Encourage steady gaze and internal focus, calming mental fluctuations
- Support prolonged meditation and breath awareness, leading to mental tranquility
- Help reduce stress and anxiety, promoting emotional balance

15. Define sarvangasana and mention the body part that mainly supports weight in it. [K] / [CO3, CO6]

Ans :

- Sarvangasana: A shoulder stand pose, also known as Shoulder Stand.
- where the body is inverted and supported by the shoulders, neck, and head.
- Body part supporting weight: Shoulders (and partially neck and head).

16. Analyze the importance of warming up before practicing ustrasana. [An]/[CO3,CO6]

Ans :- Warming up:

- Increases flexibility and prepares the spine, shoulders, and chest for the backbend.
- Reduces risk of injury to the neck, shoulders, and lower back.
- Enhances blood flow and reduces stiffness in the muscles.
- Helps prevent strain on the knees and ankles.

17. Analyze how natarajasana helps in improving body coordination. [An]/[CO3,CO6]

Ans : - Natarajasana:

- Requires balance and focus, engaging core and leg muscles to maintain posture.
- Develops coordination between upper and lower body, promoting overall balance and stability.
- Enhances proprioception (body awareness) and neuromuscular control.
- Improves concentration and mental focus, supporting physical alignment and balance.

18. How does pranayama practice help athletes in endurance sports?[K]/[CO2,CO6]

Ans : Pranayama practice:

- Enhances lung capacity and oxygen efficiency, boosting endurance

- Reduces stress and anxiety, promoting mental toughness and focus
- Improves cardiovascular health and regulates breathing patterns
- Increases overall physical and mental stamina, supporting prolonged performance.
- Sports eg : cricket , basketball, runners and sprinters .

19. How does practicing surya namaskara help in weight reduction? [U]/[CO2]

Ans : Surya Namaskara:

- Boosts metabolism and burns calories through dynamic movement
- Engages core and major muscle groups, increasing energy expenditure and fat loss
- Reduces stress and emotional eating, supporting weight management
- Improves digestion and regulates appetite, promoting overall weight balance.

20. How does pranayama help in calming the mind during anxiety ? [U]/[CO2]

Ans : Pranayama:

- Regulates breathing patterns, slowing down heart rate and promoting relaxation
- Reduces stress hormones like cortisol, calming the nervous system
- Increases oxygen flow to the brain, promoting mental clarity and focus
- Activates parasympathetic response, reducing anxiety and promoting inner peace.

21. Write any two benefits of practising yoga regularly in daily life. [An]/[CO3]

Ans :

a) Reduce cortisol level :

- Regular yoga practice help reduce cortisol (the stress hormone)
- It reduce tension and anxiety.

b) Improves emotional stability :

- Yoga helps helps individuals respond to a situation calmlyrather than reacting emotionally.

c) Balance the nervous system :

- Activates the parasympathetic (rest and digest) which calms the body .

22 . Define the role of yoga in preventing sports injuries. [K]/[CO4]

Ans : Yoga:

- Increases flexibility, strength, and balance, reducing injury risk
- Enhances body awareness, improving technique and movement patterns
- Strengthens core and stabilizer muscles, supporting joints and preventing strains
- Promotes recovery and reduces inflammation, minimizing downtime and injury impact.

[2×10= 20]

PART - C

SHORT ESSAY QUESTIONS :

Write any 4 questions.

Each question carries 4 marks.

23. Analyze the interconnectedness of dharana , dhyana and samadhi in Patanjali's path of yoga . [An]/[CO1,CO2]

Ans :

a) Dharana (concentration) :

- holding the minds , focus on one object or point .
- could be a breath , a candle plane , a mantra or an image .
- helps in training the mind to avoid distractions.
- foundation of meditation.

b) Dhyana (meditation) :

- deep , interrupted flow of concentration.
- a meditative state , where awareness is continuous.
- Brings peace , insights and calmness.

c) Samadhi (enlightenment or bliss) :

- The final stage of spiritual absorption and unity.
- The ego disappears and one feels oneness within the universe.
- it is a state of ultimate freedom and realisation.

- Interconnectedness:

- Dharana → Dhyana → Samadhi: Progressive stages of mental refinement

- Each stage builds upon the previous, cultivating deeper awareness and unity

- Together, they form the meditative path (Samyama) leading to Self-realization.

24 why is control of prana considered crucial in hatha yoga ?Importance of Prana Control: [U]/[CO1,CO2]

Ans :

- Pranayama is the bridge between body and mind .
- Prana-"life force" - energy carried by breathe .
- Pranayama regulates sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous system and also help to calm the mind. -

Benefits of prana :

- Regulates vital energy, promoting health and well-being.
- Enhances physical and mental strength, flexibility, and clarity.
- Prepares body and mind for higher states of consciousness.
- Facilitates Kundalini awakening and spiritual growth.
- Leads to mastery over body and mind, achieving Hatha Yoga's goals.

- Methods of Prana Control:

- Asanas: Physical postures to purify and balance Nadis.
- Pranayama: Breathing techniques to regulate Prana flow.
- Mudras and Bandhas: Energy locks to direct Prana.
- Meditation: Focused awareness to harness and balance Prana.

25. Describe the steps to perform utkatasana and mention it's precautions. [K]/[CO3,CO6]

Ans : Steps to perform Utkatasana:

- Stand with feet hip-width apart, arms by your sides.
- Inhale, raise arms overhead, parallel to each other.
- Exhale, bend knees, lower hips as if sitting back.
- Keep back straight, engage core, gaze forward.
- Hold, breathe deeply, then release.

- Precautions:

- Avoid if you have knee or hip injuries, or chronic back pain.
- Modify or avoid if you have low blood pressure or dizziness.
- Engage core, keep back straight to prevent strain.
- Don't hold breath, breathe naturally or as instructed.
- Listen to your body, come out of pose if discomfort arises.

26. Analyze the role of paschimottasana in stress reduction and calming the mind. [An]/[CO3,CO6]

Ans : Paschimottasana (Seated Forward Bend):

- Stretches posterior chain, releasing physical tension
- Calms nervous system, reducing stress and anxiety
- Encourages introspection, promoting mental relaxation
- Regulates breath, slowing down heart rate and promoting calmness
- Quiets mind, promoting sense of inner peace and tranquility

- Benefits for Stress Reduction:

- Reduces cortisol levels, alleviating stress symptoms
- Relaxes spinal muscles, releasing back tension
- Improves circulation, nourishing brain and promoting relaxation
- Enhances parasympathetic activity, counteracting stress response
- Fosters mindfulness, reducing mental chatter and promoting calm focus

27. How do balancing asanas improve neuro muscular coordination ? [U]/[CO3,CO6]

Ans : Balancing Asanas:

- Challenge proprioception, enhancing body awareness
- Engage core and stabilizer muscles, refining movement patterns
- Require focus and concentration, improving neural connections
- Enhance synaptic plasticity, adapting to new motor skills
- Develop neuromuscular harmony, optimizing movement efficiency
- Improvements in Neuro-Muscular Coordination:
- Enhanced proprioception and kinesthetic awareness
- Improved reaction time and motor response
- Increased core strength and stability.
- Better balance and posture control.
- More efficient movement patterns and reduced injury risk.

28. Discuss the physical benefits of chaturanga dandasana in terms of calorie burning and toning of the upper body. [K]/[CO4]

Ans : Chaturanga Dandasana (Four-Limbed Staff Pose):

- Engages entire body, boosting calorie burn and metabolism
- Targets upper body, toning arms, shoulders, and chest
- Strengthens core, improving overall stability and power
- Improves posture, reducing injury risk and enhancing physique
- Enhances endurance, supporting overall fitness and athleticism
- Calorie Burning and Toning Benefits:
- Activates major muscle groups, increasing energy expenditure
- Engages arms and shoulders, toning and strengthening muscles
- Defines chest and upper back, improving overall upper body shape
- Boosts cardiovascular health, supporting weight management
- Develops functional strength, enhancing daily activity performance

[5×4=20]